FRANCESCO RUGGIERI

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University of Virginia, Department of Economics, Charlottesville, VA 22904

Academic Positions

University of Virginia, Assistant Professor, Department of Economics 2026–present

University of Chicago, Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Economics 2024–2026

Education

University of Chicago, Ph.D. in Economics 2024

London School of Economics and Political Science, M.Sc. in Economics 2016

Università Bocconi, B.Sc. in Economics and Social Sciences 2015

Northwestern University, Exchange Student Fall 2014

Research and Teaching Fields

Primary: Public Finance, Urban Economics
Secondary: Applied Microeconometrics

Working Papers

Dynamic Regression Discontinuity: An Event-Study Approach
Revision requested, ***Journal of Econometrics***

Abstract: *I propose a novel argument to identify economically interpretable intertemporal treatment effects in dynamic regression discontinuity designs (RDDs). Specifically, I develop a dynamic potential outcomes model and reformulate two assumptions from the difference-in-differences literature—no anticipation and common trends—to attain point identification of cutoff-specific impulse responses. The estimand of each target parameter can be expressed as the sum of two static RDD contrasts, thereby allowing for nonparametric estimation and inference with standard local polynomial methods. I also propose a nonparametric approach to aggregate treatment effects across calendar time and treatment paths, leveraging a limited path independence restriction to reduce the dimensionality of the parameter space. I apply this method to estimate the dynamic effects of school district expenditure authorizations on housing prices in Wisconsin.*

Does Family Caregiving Complement Formal Care? Daughters and Parental Survival After a Severe Health Shock (with Elin Colmsjö and Matteo Saccarola)

Abstract: *We study how informal family caregiving and formal care interact after severe parental health shocks, and whether they operate as substitutes or complements. Using Danish administrative data, we compare parents of only children who experience a stroke at the same age and differ only in the gender of their child. Before the stroke, parents of daughters and parents of sons follow similar health trajectories, with comparable levels of pre-existing conditions and healthcare utilization. After the stroke, a survival gap opens and grows, and parents of daughters are 1.5 percentage points more likely to be alive by year five. Over the same period, daughters adjust more than sons along several margins: they become more likely to live near their parents, less likely to be married, and have fewer children, consistent with greater involvement in informal caregiving. Crucially, parents of daughters use more physical rehabilitation, an elective type of formal care that requires sustained engagement. Rather than crowding out formal provision, daughters appear more likely to help parents navigate and use professional services. Informal and formal care can therefore operate, at least in part, as complements in the response to severe health shocks.*

Overlapping Jurisdictions and the Provision of Local Public Goods in U.S. Metropolitan Areas

Abstract: *Local governments in the United States are vertically differentiated: in a given location, multiple overlapping jurisdictions provide distinct local public services and draw revenue from shared portions of the property tax base. This paper estimates the fiscal spillovers generated by this structure and proposes a mechanism that internalizes them in local policy choice. I assemble a new georeferenced dataset covering the universe of local government boundaries and nominal property tax rates nationwide over the past two decades. Using a dynamic regression discontinuity design, I estimate fiscal spillovers from narrowly approved property tax referenda. To extrapolate beyond effects identified at the approval threshold, I develop a spatial equilibrium model with overlapping jurisdictions and majority voting over the provision of local public goods. I use the model to quantify spillovers for all school districts and municipal governments in the United States and find sizable effects. I then evaluate a policy that (i) informs voters about cross-jurisdiction spillovers and (ii) applies symmetric intergovernmental transfers (taxes or subsidies) upon approval of a spending change. The counterfactual regime yields aggregate welfare gains.*

Structural Extrapolation in Regression Discontinuity Designs with an Application to School Expenditure Referenda (with Austin Feng)

Abstract: *We propose a structural approach to extrapolate average partial effects away from the cutoff in regression discontinuity designs (RDDs). Our focus is on applications that exploit closely contested school district referenda to estimate the effects of changes in education spending on local economic outcomes. We embed these outcomes in a spatial equilibrium model of local jurisdictions in which fiscal policy is determined by majority rule voting. This integration provides a microfoundation for the running variable—the share of voters who approve a ballot initiative—and enables identification of structural parameters using RDD coefficients. We then leverage the model to simulate the effects of counterfactual referenda over a broad range of proposed spending changes. These scenarios imply realizations of the running variable away from the threshold, allowing extrapolation of RDD estimates to nonmarginal referenda. Applying the method to school expenditure ballot measures in Wisconsin, we document substantial heterogeneity in housing price capitalization across the approval margin.*

The Geography of the U.S. Property Tax

Abstract: *I construct a novel, granular georeferenced dataset on the universe of local governments in the United States and their property tax rates from the early 2000s to 2022. Using this dataset, I present new descriptive insights on the geography of the property tax. First, property tax rates exhibit substantial variation within states, surpassing that of any other local tax. Second, rates are higher in locations where a greater number of jurisdictions overlap and thus share tax base. Third, rates are higher in areas with larger dispersion in property values and greater racial and ethnic heterogeneity. Fourth, new local taxing jurisdictions are more likely to be formed in locations where the distribution of income is more even and dispersion in housing values is lower.*

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

University of Virginia	Public Economics (G)	Spring 2027
University of Virginia	Seminar in Policy Analysis (UG)	Spring 2027
University of Virginia	Introduction to Econometrics (UG)	Fall 2026
University of Chicago	Honors Econometrics (UG)	Winter 2022
University of Chicago	Econometrics (UG)	Spring 2021

Teaching Assistant

University of Chicago	Honors Econometrics (UG)	A. Torgovitsky	Winter 2021
University of Chicago	Applied Microeconometrics (G)	A. Torgovitsky	Autumn 2020
University of Chicago	Honors Econometrics (UG)	P. Hull	Spring 2020
University of Chicago	Honors Econometrics (UG)	A. Torgovitsky	Winter 2020
University of Chicago	Econometrics (UG)	C. Roark	Autumn 2019
London School of Economics	Microeconomic Principles (UG)	E. Eyster	Lent 2016

Scholarships and Grants

Metcalf Summer Internship Program Grant ($6,320), Becker Friedman Institute for Economics 2024

C.V. Starr Scholarship, University of Chicago Department of Economics 2023–2024

C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy 2023

Metcalf Summer Internship Program Grant ($20,000), Becker Friedman Institute for Economics 2023

Progress of Ideas Grant ($7,500), Robert Schalkenbach Foundation 2023

Data Acquisition Grant ($3,000), University of Chicago Department of Economics 2022

Neubauer Fellowship, University of Chicago 2018–2023

Social Sciences Division Fellowship, University of Chicago 2018–2023

Awards

Wayne C. Booth Graduate Student Prize for Excellence in Teaching, University of Chicago 2023

Outstanding Undergraduate Teaching Award, University of Chicago Department of Economics 2021

Teaching Award for Excellent Feedback and Communication, London School of Economics 2016

Invited Seminars

2026–27 Stony Brook University

2025–26 University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill; University of Maryland; Indiana University O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs; University of Mannheim; University of Manchester; City University of Hong Kong; Bank of Italy; University of Pennsylvania Wharton School; University of Arkansas; University of Virginia

2024–25 Syracuse-Chicago Webinar Series on Property Tax Administration and Design

Conference Presentations

2026–27 NBER Summer Institute Urban Economics and Real Estate; Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) Public Economics; Southern Economic Association (SEA) 96th Annual Meeting

2025–26 National Tax Association (NTA) 118th Annual Conference; 15th European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (UEA); 2026 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) National Conference

Discussions

2025–26 Brookings 14th Annual Municipal Finance Conference; National Tax Association (NTA) 118th Annual Conference; Syracuse-Chicago Webinar Series on Property Tax Administration and Design; 15th European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (UEA); 2026 American Real Estate and Urban Economics Association (AREUEA) National Conference

Refereeing Activity

American Economic Review, *European Economic Review*, *Journal of Political Economy*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Regional Science and Urban Economics*

Professional Service

University of Chicago, Department of Economics

Organizer of the Chicago Causal Inference Student Conference	2024
Co-organizer of the Student Applied Microeconomics Lunch	2021–2023
Organizer of the Difference-in-Differences Reading Group	2022
Cohort Representative in the Graduate Student Liaison	2020–2021
Co-organizer of the Empirics and Methods in Economics Conference (EMCON)	2020
Organizer of the Structural Econometrics Reading Group	2020

Prior Academic Employment

Research Assistant for Michael Greenstone, University of Chicago	2019–2021
Research Assistant for Eric Zwick, University of Chicago	2019–2020
Research Professional, Princeton University Department of Economics	2018
Research Professional, University of Chicago Booth School of Business	2016–2018

References

Professor Michael Greenstone
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
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Professor Magne Mogstad
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Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
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Professor Alexander Torgovitsky
University of Chicago
Kenneth C. Griffin Department of Economics
atorgovitsky@gmail.com

Additional Information

Citizenship	Italy
Languages	Italian (Native), English (Fluent), French (Good)